

# Psalms 6

## A Cry for Mercy

Have mercy upon me, O Lord; for I am weak  
KJV · Standalone study handout

### 1 • THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 O LORD, rebuke me not in thine anger, neither chasten me in thy hot displeasure.
- 2 Have mercy upon me, O LORD; for I am weak: O LORD, heal me; for my bones are vexed.
- 3 My soul is also sore vexed: but thou, O LORD, how long?
- 4 Return, O LORD, deliver my soul: oh save me for thy mercies' sake.
- 5 For in death there is no remembrance of thee: in the grave who shall give thee thanks?
- 6 I am weary with my groaning; all the night make I my bed to swim; I water my couch with my tears.
- 7 Mine eye is consumed because of grief; it waxeth old because of all mine enemies.
- 8 Depart from me, all ye workers of iniquity; for the LORD hath heard the voice of my weeping.
- 9 The LORD hath heard my supplication; the LORD will receive my prayer.
- 10 Let all mine enemies be ashamed and sore vexed: let them return and be ashamed suddenly.

### 2 • CONTEXT

The first of the traditional penitential psalms. David pleads under God's discipline and human hostility—body and soul exhausted with tears. Henry traces the movement from fear of wrath, through weak pleading, to confident assurance that the Lord has heard. Sorrow is real; so is answered prayer.

### 3 • VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

#### Verse 1-3

Plea not to be rebuked in anger or chastened in hot displeasure. Weakness is total—bones and soul vexed. The cry “how long?” is honest faith, not unbelief.

#### Verse 4-5

Appeal to covenant mercy: return, deliver, save. Argument from worship: the dead cannot remember or thank God as the living do—so spare for His praise's sake.

#### Verse 6-7

Depth of grief: nights of tears, eyes wasted by sorrow and enemies. The psalm legitimizes exhausted lament without cosplay toughness.

#### Verse 8-10

Turning: workers of iniquity are told to depart—the Lord has heard weeping and will receive prayer. Enemies will be ashamed and turned back. Assurance arrives before circumstances fully change.

### 4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

#### Meaning.

God's people may feel both divine discipline and human pressure until strength fails. Mercy, not merit, is the plea. God hears tears; confidence can return while eyes are still wet.

#### Application for life today.

If you are weak, this psalm gives you words—do not wait until you feel strong to pray. Distinguish condemnation-panic from Fatherly discipline; ask for mercy. When grief floods the night, remember verse 8–9: the Lord has heard. Let assurance push back both despair and the voices of those who rejoice in your pain.

### 5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Where do you need to pray “how long?” honestly before God this week?

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2. How does appealing to God’s mercy (not your strength) reshape a current struggle?

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3. What would change if you believed God has already heard your weeping?

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Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_ Group / Church: \_\_\_\_\_

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).